

Question:

What is the de Broglie wavelength of an electron with a kineticenergy of 1eV?

Answer Choices:

- A. 2.48×10^{-8} cm
- B. 5.92×10^7 cm/sec
- C. 8.66×10^{-6} cm
- D. 3.14×10^{-5} cm
- E. 9.81×10^{-4} cm
- F. 5.27×10^{-9} m
- G. 1.23×10^{-7} cm
- H. 4.14×10^{-10} m
- I. 6.625×10^{-27} erg sec
- J. 0.512×10^6 eV

Reasoning + Answer:

</tool_call> reasoning process here

The de Broglie wavelength λ of a particle is given by :

$$\lambda = h / p$$

where :

- h = Planck 's constant = 6.626×10^{-34} J $\cdot$ s = 6.626×10^{-27} erg $\cdot$ s
- p is the momentum of the particle

For a non-relativistic electron with kinetic energy K , the kinetic energy is :

$$K = p^2 / (2m)$$

So ,

$$p = \sqrt{2mK}$$

Thus ,

$$\lambda = h / \sqrt{2mK}$$

We need to compute the de Broglie wavelength for an electron with kinetic energy $K = 1$ eV .

First , convert 1 eV to joules :

$$1 \text{ eV} = 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J}$$

Mass of electron $m = 9.109 \times 10^{-31}$ kg

So ,

$$\begin{aligned} p &= \sqrt{2 \times 9.109 \times 10^{-31} \times 1.602 \times 10^{-19}} \\ &= \sqrt{2 \times 9.109 \times 1.602 \times 10^{-50} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m}^2 \cdot \text{s}^{-2}} \\ &= \sqrt{2.92 \times 10^{-49} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m}^2 \cdot \text{s}^{-2}} \\ &= 1.71 \times 10^{-24} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m/s} \end{aligned}$$

Now ,

$$\lambda = h / p = (6.626 \times 10^{-34}) / (1.71 \times 10^{-24} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m/s})$$
$$= 3.87 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$$

Convert to cm : $3.87 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m} = 3.87 \times 10^{-8} \text{ cm}$

Now compare to the options :

- A. 2.48×10^{-8} cm $\approx 2.48 \times 10^{-10}$ m $\approx$ too small
- B. 5.92×10^7 cm/sec $\approx$ unit is wrong (velocity)
- C. 8.66×10^{-6} cm $\approx 8.66 \times 10^{-8}$ m $\approx$ too small
- D. 3.14×10^{-5} cm $\approx 3.14 \times 10^{-7}$ m $\approx$ close but low
- E. 9.81×10^{-4} cm $\approx 10^{-6}$ m $\approx$ wrong
- F. 5.27×10^{-9} m $\approx 5.27 \times 10^{-11}$ cm $\approx$ not matching
- G. 1.23×10^{-7} cm $\approx 1.23 \times 10^{-9}$ m $\approx$ too small
- H. 4.14×10^{-10} m $\approx 4.14 \times 10^{-12}$ cm $\approx$ smaller than calculated
- I. 6.625×10^{-27} erg sec $\approx$ unit is h , not wavelength
- J. 0.512×10^6 eV $\approx$ energy , not wavelength

Now verify with exact known formula :

For electrons , a handy approximation is :

$$\lambda \text{ (in nm)} = 1.226 / \sqrt{K \text{ (in eV)}}$$

So for $K = 1$ eV ,

$$\lambda = 1.226 / \sqrt{1} = 1.226 \text{ nm} = 1.226 \times 10^{-9} \text{ m} = 1.226 \times 10^{-11} \text{ cm}$$

Wait $\hat{G}$ something seems off .

Wait: the standard formula is :

$$\lambda \text{ (in nanometers)} = 1.22$$